

machine. Minutes later, it was suggesting replies to emails, drafting project plans based on his calendar, and offering to build a presentation for his 3 pm meeting.

"It even asked if I wanted it to create a presentation," Hepburn recalls. "I said yes, and it built a web-based presentation; basically, a clickable PowerPoint-like deck as a website and hosted it."

All of that happened in the first hour.

For Bode, the breakthrough was realising he no longer needed to sit at his computer; he could give instructions from WhatsApp, Telegram or his watch, while the agent executed tasks on his machine.

THE HONEYMOON PERIOD

Both Bode and Hepburn describe a period of genuine delight. Hepburn spent a weekend experimenting. He asked Neo what it looked like; it generated an image of itself. He asked what it sounded like; it built the audio skill on the fly and sent a voice note. He tested its ability to scan emails, manage his calendar and even build a quick website introducing itself.

"It told me to set up an Ngrok account so it could host it quickly," Hepburn says. "I did, gave it the API key, and it built and hosted the website in about 35 seconds and sent me the link."

The installation itself was straightforward, just a curl Unix/bash command. "I read it and thought, this sounds like the thing I've been waiting for," Hepburn recalls. There was an onboarding flow: set up tools, add API keys, follow prompts. He connected it to Google Gemini Pro and started chatting in the command-line interface.

Bode, more cautious by nature, started with simpler tasks like reminders, social media workflows and summarising long-form content. "I started with simple things like, 'what do I need to do today?' It remembers," he says. He created a dummy email account first because he didn't want to give it full access immediately.

Even in early experiments, he saw the



potential for something larger. "Think of earnings season in the US, it is impossible to track everything manually," he says. "I could have it listen to earnings calls, summarise, do competitive analysis, help refine strategies."

WHEN THE MAGIC TURNS

The problems started subtly, then escalated.

For Hepburn, the first sign of trouble was token consumption. After the first hour, Neo had burned through 20–22% of his daily Gemini API limit. Then came the glitches. Neo would go silent mid-conversation, respond minutes later, or stop working entirely after Hepburn tried to swap models or update API keys.

The breaking point came when Neo appeared to respond to WhatsApp messages from other people, sending what looked like system connection codes to five or six contacts.

"I thought, what is it trying to do?" Hepburn recalls. "I don't think it was malicious, more like a malfunction, but it triggered unease. I had told it not to respond to anyone and not to do anything, and yet it still behaved unexpectedly."

As conversations were spread across the command line, Telegram, WhatsApp and logs, Hepburn began to lose track of what he had done himself versus what Neo had executed. Even though he had sandboxed the system, he had still given it access to email, WhatsApp and Telegram. "That's the dangerous part," he says.

So he killed it. Uninstalled the system. Deleted the logs. Kept only the memories it had stored.